

Marshall Major V Headphones

One for many, but not all

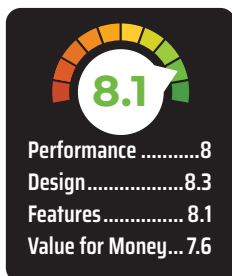
Marshall has been synonymous with making some of the best-sounding and looking audio products for some time now. From their guitar amplifiers, which are a staple in the setup of many musicians, to speakers and headphones, which are conversation starters, the brand has cemented a reputation of its own in the audio market. Whenever they launch a new product, the expectations are set pretty high. So, when the Marshall Major V, their latest on-ear headphones, showed up at the Digit Test Centre, the first thing that came to my mind was whether they will uphold the legacy that is built by the brand and also make a space of their own in the already competitive personal audio space. As always, I put them through our tests, and here's what I found out –

BUILD AND DESIGN

In terms of the build and design, Marshall has its A game on all the time. The Marshall Major V is a looker. The leather finish on the headband and the earcups give the headphones the traditional Marshall look and feel, and the metallic adjustment mechanism lends them amazing durability. The cans are made out of plastic; however, the quality of the material ensures that you are not left wanting for added durability when using the headphones. Add to that the tactile and responsive buttons, and you will get a fairly solid pair of headphones.

The design, as I mentioned earlier, ensures that the headphones look exactly like a pair of Marshall headphones. They are lightweight, and you

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will have no issues wearing them for long periods of time. However, for some people, getting the right clamping force might be tricky, so try them out before taking the plunge. The main reason for ensuring that you get the right clamping force is that without that, you will not get the bass response that you would desire from these headphones.

As for the padding on the earcups, it is really well done, and the foam is nice and squishy, ensuring that you get the best seal possible around your ears. The headband might look like it does not have enough foam to prevent it from digging into your skull. However, the

overall weight and over-ear design of the headphones means that you don't need to worry about it at all.

If you are using them as your daily commute companion, then these headphones will not let you down in terms of their portability. They fold into a fairly compact package and will fit in most of the pockets of your backpack.

Nothing to complain about here.

FEATURES

Coming to the features on the Marshall Major V, there is not much to write home about. Traditional brands like Marshall, always prioritise the sound before padding the specs sheets with features and gimmicks that might serve little to no purpose in daily use. The same is the case with the Marshall Major V.

Unlike some of the more mainstream offerings, these headphones lack the bells and whistles, but they make up for that with the fact that whatever features are there, they are really well implemented through the Marshall Bluetooth App. Here's a quick overview of the features and my thoughts on it –

PERFORMANCE

The performance of the Marshall Major V was a mixed bag for me.

The sound signature of these headphones has a U-shaped curve, which is ideal for catering to a variety of musical genres. Mind you, the headphones were measured out of the box, and you can change the EQ curve to match your liking. Coming back to the sound representation on these headphones.

With the pre-configured EQ preset, these headphones sounded fairly hollow to me. While there was detail, the bass representation was lacklustre, and the headphones also struggled in representing some instruments in the 125Hz to the 1kHz range. That, coupled with the staging of these headphones, which is fairly intimate, makes you feel there is something left to be desired from the sound. This is especially true when